Mermaid Roshan
and the Song Beneath the Pool

Rumi's undersea adventure

A little voice. A whole city listening.

Roshan joins Rumi, Hana and Nari in the city beneath Pearl Castle.
And a little turtle has something important to tell them.

The castle's candle was still missing.
But Rumi's pool shimmered, and its rainbow kept turning.

"Come and sing with my friends," said Rumi.
"My voice is very little," said Roshan.
Rumi held out her hand.

Down they swam, beneath the shining water.
They were still inside Pearl Castle.
A whole city glowed below.

Curved roofs. Bright shops. A bubble tram!
Roshan's tail flashed rainbow colours.
"All this was under our pool?"

Hana waved from the music room.
Her copper hair floated like a ribbon.
Nari peeped around her shoulder.

"I'm good at big dance moves," said Hana.
"I'm good at hearing tiny things," said Nari.
"I'm good at being here," said Roshan.

Rumi, Hana and Nari began.
"Little voice, big blue sea.
Sing with you, sing with me."

Usually, the city sang back.
Tonight, no answer came.
Between the notes, Roshan heard:
Tap. Tap. Tap.

"Wait," whispered Roshan.
"Someone is asking for help."
She followed the tapping beneath the tram bridge.

A little turtle was caught between two prop crates.
A soft concert banner tangled round his shell.
"I'm Duri," he said. "I'm stuck."

"We'll make you a space," said Roshan.
Rumi held the banner loose.
Roshan pushed one crate away.

Hana steadied the other crate.
Nari counted, "One, two, gently!"
Duri wriggled free.
"You heard me!"

They rested in the warm-current bathhouse.
Duri stopped trembling.
Roshan sang him a very little song.

"Make a space and let it through.
There's a place for me and you."
Nari hummed beside her.
Duri smiled.

Then a top hat bobbed past.
A purple imp popped out of the bubbles.
"The stage is ours tonight!" he squeaked.

Another imp dragged a glittery prop crate.
Duri pointed after them.
"They piled those in our current channel."

Duri led them through a quiet passage.
At the concert terrace, ribbons barely stirred.
Crates were jammed against the current gate.

"The song can't reach our neighbours," said Rumi.
Hana raised her chin. Nari listened.
Roshan looked at the gap beneath the crates.

They swam up to the shell stage.
"Move your props, please," said Roshan.
The imps stuck out their tongues.

Rumi took the first note.
Hana swept into a bright dance.
Nari beat the rhythm.
Roshan swam straight towards the gate.

POOF! A cloud of bubbles!
WHOOSH! A flying foam star!
Hana caught it on a soft banner.

Nari ducked. Rumi spun.
Roshan swept a ribbon around the wobbling crate.
The imps bounced backwards onto cushions.

"Now," said Roshan.
Rumi held the ribbon with her.
Hana pushed. Nari pulled.
Together, they moved the last crate.

Duri slipped through the open arch.
The current rushed after him.
Blue light curled round the stage.
The magic had been there all along.

The shops answered first.
Then the bathhouse. Then the tram.
Little voices travelled through the bright blue city.

Roshan sang with Rumi, Hana and Nari.
She did not sing the loudest.
But this time, she heard everyone.

The imps peeked over their cushions.
"Is there a place for us?"
"Yes," said Roshan. "If you make space for others."

They carried the crates away.
One played a tiny bell. One took a bow.
Even Duri joined in:
Tap. Tap. Tap.

At last, Rumi and Roshan swam home.
Above them, the familiar rainbow turned.
The seahorse fountain splashed its welcome.

"We haven't found the candle yet," said Roshan.
"No," said Rumi. "But today you heard a friend."
And somewhere below, a little turtle tapped goodnight.

Sing with me

Little voice, big blue sea.
Sing with you, sing with me.
Make a space and let it through.
There's a place for me and you.

Who will you hear?

Beneath Rumi's swimming pool lies a glowing mermaid city.
But when its song falls quiet, Roshan hears a tiny tap.
Can four friends make room for one little voice?

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Original refrain and new supporting characters for this story.